

Paraguay vs Australia

Thursday, June 25, 2026 — 10:00 PM ET / 7:00 PM PT / 10:00 AM MYT (Jun 26) / 02:00 UTC (Jun 26).
Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara, CA. Entertainment-oriented pre-match analysis; not investment advice.

PY

Paraguay

3 pts · GD -2 · Missing Almirón

VS

Australia

3 pts · GD 0 · Popovic 3-5-2

AU

Report updated: June 25, 2026. Exchange rate basis: ECB reference **1 EUR = 1.08 USD** (June 24, 2026).
Overseas moneyline/totals from DraftKings/ESPN-style markets reviewed; local retail fixed-odds availability
not verified in this environment. Confirm prices and sales cutoff at your sportsbook before purchase.

Key Takeaways

Crucial Qualifier

Winner takes 2nd; draw sends both through. USA already won Group D; Türkiye eliminated.

Market: Tight

De-vigged baseline — Paraguay 36.8%, Draw 31.3%, Australia 31.9%.

Central Path

Draw 0-0 or 1-1. Low-scoring affair; both teams incentivized to avoid risk.

Key Absence

Miguel Almirón suspended (red vs Türkiye).
Paraguay's top scorer (10 int'l goals).

Verified: Standings & Stakes

Verified: Venue & Kickoff

Assumed: Lineups & Score Path

Inference: Weather & Referee Impact

Concentrated Betting Plan

Budget: \$100 entertainment cap · **\$2 per unit** · 50 units total. Score thesis: cautious, low-scoring match where a draw qualifies both sides.

1. Core — Under 2.5 Goals

\$50 · 25 units

Approx. **+145** American. Both teams defensive-minded; draw qualifies both. Almiron absent. Paraguay held 10 men for 45+ mins vs Türkiye; Australia conservative under Popovic.

Min acceptable: -160 · **Cancel if:** Both teams confirm attacking lineups OR Paraguay must-win posture emerges pre-kickoff.

2. Adjacent — Draw

\$35 · 17.5 units

Approx. **+114 to +125**. Game theory: neither side should risk elimination in the Round of 32 race when a point advances both.

Min acceptable: +100 · **Cancel if:** One team confirmed qualified via 3rd-place math before kickoff.

3. Differential — Correct Score 0-0

\$15 · 7.5 units

Approx. **+450** (4.50 decimal). Both scored 2 goals in 2 games; limited clinical finishing; Almiron absence cripples Paraguay attack.

Min acceptable: +400 · **Cancel if:** Both teams confirmed in attacking formations.

Variance warning: Concentrated plans increase variance and may lose the entire entertainment budget. This plan allocates 100% across three correlated low-scoring paths — if the match opens up early, all legs may fail together.

Parlay Combinations (Higher Variance)

Parlay A — Under 2.5 + Draw · Combined approx. **+280** (2.80 decimal) · \$10 stake → ~\$38 return

Legs share correlation: both require a 0-0 or 1-1 outcome. Drop Draw leg if either team announces must-win tactics.

Parlay B — Draw + Correct Score 0-0 · Combined approx. **+520** (6.20 decimal) · \$8 stake → ~\$50 return

Highly correlated — true joint probability lower than independent product. Cancel if attacking lineups confirmed.

Parlay C — Under 2.5 + Correct Score 0-0 · Combined approx. **+380** (4.80 decimal) · \$6 stake → ~\$29 return

0-0 satisfies both legs. Reduce or drop if Paraguay starts Enciso + Pitta in aggressive wide roles.

Pre-Purchase Check	Action
Under 2.5 line moves to 2.0 with heavy juice	Keep Under 2.5 only if price stays ≥ -160 ; otherwise shift \$15 to Draw.
Almirón replacement (Mauricio) starts wide, Enciso central	Reduce 0-0 allocation by half; Paraguay attack slightly more live.
Leckie confirmed fit and starts	Australia attack marginally upgraded; trim 0-0 to \$10, add \$5 to Under 2.5.
Fixed bonuses below stated minimums	Do not force the bet — mark selection Not recommended.

Score Thesis

Market baseline (Assumed): Very tight three-way market — Paraguay 36.8%, Draw 31.3%, Australia 31.9%. O/U set at 1.5–2.0 with Under favored.

Adjustment	Direction	Rationale
Qualification incentive (draw advances both)	DOWN total goals	Both teams should avoid overcommitting; classic "gentleman's draw" risk.
Almirón suspension	DOWN Paraguay scoring	Leading scorer and main creative outlet absent.
Paraguay 10-man hold vs Türkiye	DOWN total goals	Defensive discipline proven under pressure.
Australia 2-0 vs Türkiye clean sheet	NO CHANGE	Solid but sample size one match; USA loss 2-0 shows ceiling.
Mild Bay Area evening (65–70°F, dry)	NO CHANGE	Neutral conditions; confirms football baseline.
Referee Clement Turpin (elite, card-aware)	NO CHANGE	Experienced control; no strong bias toward cards or pens assumed.

BTTS Lean No: Combined starter xG modest; both teams scored sparingly (2 GF each in 2 games). Almirón absence reduces Paraguay open-play threat.

Central path: Draw 0-0 or 1-1. **Alternative:** Paraguay 1-0 (Enciso/Galarza moment). **Tail risk:** Australia surprise win if Paraguay overextend chasing a winner they may not need.

Top scorer candidates (Assumed): Julio Enciso, Matías Galarza (Paraguay); Nestory Irankunda, Mohamed Toure (Australia).

Referee & Environment

Referee — Clement Turpin (France)

Experienced elite UEFA referee. **Assumed:** firm but not overly punitive; allows game flow in open-air conditions. No tournament-to-date card sample verified for WC 2026 in this report.

Score impact: NO CHANGE — neutral officiating expected.

Venue & Weather

Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara, CA — 68,500 capacity, open-air, natural grass. Evening kickoff 7:00 PM PT.

Forecast (Assumed): Mild 65–70°F, low humidity, no rain. Confirms passing baseline; no weather suppression or boost applied.

Invalidation: Heavy wind/rain pre-match would narrow central range further (DOWN goals). Referee change to high-card official would slightly widen late tail risk.

Event Background

Group D Context

48-team format; top two plus eight best third-place teams advance. USA (6 pts) has won the group. Türkiye (0 pts) eliminated. Paraguay and Australia tied on 3 points — winner guaranteed 2nd; draw likely sends both through (Australia 2nd on GD, Paraguay 3rd with strong best-third case).

Matchday 1–2 Results

MD1: USA 4-1 Paraguay; Australia 2-0 Türkiye.

MD2: USA 2-0 Australia; Paraguay 1-0 Türkiye (Almirón red, Galarza goal).

Team	P	W	D	L	GF	GA	GD	Pts
USA	2	2	0	0	6	1	+5	6
Australia	2	1	0	1	2	2	0	3
Paraguay	2	1	0	1	2	4	-2	3
Türkiye	2	0	0	2	0	3	-3	0

Team Overview

Paraguay — Gustavo Alfaro

Resilient but stretched after USA 4-1 opener. Recovered with gritty 1-0 vs Türkiye despite Almirón's red card. Without their Newcastle playmaker, creativity falls to Enciso, Diego Gómez, and Galarza. Galarza on yellow — discipline risk.

Australia — Tony Popovic

Pragmatic 3-5-2 under Popovic. Clean sheet vs Türkiye; outclassed by USA. Leckie doubtful (knock). Young forwards Irankunda and Toure carry goal threat but limited WC sample. Likely content with a point.

Factor	Paraguay	Australia
Group points	3	3
Goals scored (2 games)	2	2
Key absence	Almirón (suspended)	Leckie (doubtful)
Formation	4-2-3-1	3-5-2
H2H note	Limited recent competitive meetings; styles clash — Paraguay compact, Australia transitional.	

Predicted Starters & Tactics



Suspended: Miguel Almirón (PY). **Doubtful:** Mathew Leckie (AU). **On yellow:** Matías Galarza (PY).

Tactical Question	Watch For	Betting Impact
Will Paraguay push for a win?	Alfaro's press conferences and warm-up intensity.	If cautious, Draw and Under strengthen; if aggressive, trim 0-0.
Australia wing-back width	Italiano/Metcalfe providing width vs compact Paraguay block.	Wide overload could break 0-0 late — tail risk for Under.
Galarza discipline	Second yellow ends Paraguay midfield control.	Red card widens variance; could flip to Australia win tail.
Enciso isolation	Can he create without Almirón's movement?	Paraguay 1-0 alternative path lives or dies here.

Full Squads — Parallel Roster

PY

Paraguay

MANAGER

GA

Gustavo Alfaro

Head Coach

Experienced South American tactician; defensive organization priority.

FORWARDS

IP

Isidro Pitta

START

26 · \$3.5M

#9 · ST · 185cm/80kg · Ludogorets

MA

Mauricio

START

24 · \$2.8M

#11 · RW · 175cm/70kg · Replaces Almirón

MA

Miguel Almirón

SUSP

31 · \$18M

#10 · AM · 174cm/69kg · Newcastle — Red card ban

MIDFIELDERS

JE

Julio Enciso

START

21 · \$22M

#19 · AM · 173cm/73kg · Brighton

DG

Diego Gómez

START

22 · \$12M

#20 · AM · 185cm/78kg · Inter Miami

MG

Matías Galarza

YC

23 · \$5M

#16 · CM · 177cm/72kg · Talleres — On yellow

AC

Andrés Cubas

START

29 · \$8M

#6 · DM · 165cm/60kg · Vancouver

DEFENDERS

GG

Gustavo Gómez

START

32 · \$4M

#3 · CB · 185cm/85kg · Palmeiras · Captain

OA

Omar Alderete

START

29 · \$6M

#5 · CB · 188cm/84kg · Getafe

JA

Júnior Alonso

START

32 · \$2M

#15 · LB · 185cm/78kg · Atlético Mineiro

JC

Juan Cáceres

START

24 · \$4M

#2 · RB · 178cm/72kg · Lyon

AU

Australia

MANAGER

TP

Tony Popovic

Head Coach

Defensive 3-5-2 specialist; pragmatic tournament approach.

FORWARDS

NI

Nestory Irankunda

START

19 · \$6M

#17 · ST · 183cm/78kg · Watford

MT

Mohamed Toure

START

20 · \$3M

#13 · ST · 188cm/82kg · Randers

MIDFIELDERS

AO

Aidan O'Neill

START

27 · \$5M

#8 · CM · 178cm/72kg · Millwall

CM

Connor Metcalfe

START

26 · \$2.5M

#23 · CM · 180cm/75kg · St. Pauli

SO

Sam Okon-Engstler

START

22 · \$4M

#14 · CM · 185cm/78kg · Mainz

GS

Gianni Stensness

START

26 · \$3M

#6 · WB · 185cm/80kg · Viking

DI

Dante Italiano

START

21 · \$2M

#2 · WB · 175cm/68kg · Melbourne City

DEFENDERS

HS

Harry Souttar

START

27 · \$8M

#4 · CB · 198cm/95kg · Sheffield Utd

CB

Cameron Burgess

START

30 · \$3M

#5 · CB · 194cm/88kg · Ipswich

KR

Kye Rowles

START

27 · \$4M

#3 · CB · 185cm/82kg · Hearts

ML

Mathew Leckie

DOUBT

33 · \$1.5M

#7 · LW · 181cm/78kg · Melbourne City — Knock

GOALKEEPERS



Orlando Gill

START

24 · \$1.5M

#1 · GK · 193cm/88kg · OH Leuven

GOALKEEPERS



Joe Beach

START

22 · \$1M

#12 · GK · 188cm/85kg · Melbourne City

Odds & Probabilities

Paraguay 36.8%

Slight favorite despite GD deficit; home-continent crowd edge in Bay Area.

Draw 31.3%

Game-theory premium; both teams may settle.

Australia 31.9%

Live if Paraguay overcommits or Galarza sent off.

Market	Range (American)	Interpretation
Moneyline	PY +190/+200 · Draw +114/+125 · AU +240/+310	Three-way coin flip; no clear dominant side.
Total Goals	O/U 1.5–2.0 · Under favored	Market expects 0–2 goals; aligns with thesis.
Correct Score 0-0	~+450	Differential play; correlated with Draw + Under.
Under 2.5	~-145	Core selection; safer than exact score.

Quick guide: Moneyline = 90-minute result (win/draw/loss). **+190** = bet \$100 to win \$190. **-145** = bet \$145 to win \$100. **Under 2.5** wins on 0, 1, or 2 total goals. Correct score requires exact final score.

Risk Checklist

Lineup Uncertainty

Predicted XIs are Assumed; confirm ~1 hr before kickoff.

Correlation Risk

All three picks need a low-scoring game; single early goal damages entire plan.

Gentleman's Draw

Ethical/regulatory scrutiny possible; FIFA may monitor late-group dead rubbers.

Leckie Fitness

If fit, Australia attack upgrades; reassess 0-0 allocation.

Maximum entertainment budget: **\$100** — do not chase losses. If prices fall below minimum thresholds, mark selections Not recommended rather than forcing plays.

Sources

- [FIFA World Cup 2026 — Official Tournament Hub](#)
- [FIFA — Group Stage Qualification Rules](#)
- [ESPN — Paraguay Squad & Fixtures](#)
- [ESPN — Australia Squad & Fixtures](#)
- [Transfermarkt — Paraguay Market Values](#)
- [Transfermarkt — Australia Market Values](#)
- [Levi's Stadium — Venue Information](#)
- [Sofascore — World Cup Stats & xG](#)
- Match context, standings, odds, and lineups: user-provided briefing (June 25, 2026) — Assumed where not independently re-verified.

Entertainment-only analysis. Predictions for lineups, scores, and betting allocations are Assumed unless officially confirmed. No guaranteed returns. Minors are not permitted to wager. Bet responsibly within your stated budget.